

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Jokes, emojis, urgency and 'Yo!'

Johnson's texts reveal governing style and intrigue at Chicago City Hall

By Jake Sheridan, Alice Yin and Gregory Royal Pratt
Chicago Tribune

The text from Chicago Mayor Brandon Johnson started as his messages often do.

"Yo!" he wrote Ald. Daniel La Spata, 1st, last month.

The Northwest Side alderman knew what it meant. "That's when I called him," he remembered.

A Tribune review of Johnson's text messages show many politicians have gotten similar messages and read between those two letters themselves.

The mayor's exchanges with aldermen, Gov. JB Pritzker, top business officials and labor leaders show he is more reluctant than predecessors Lori Lightfoot and Rahm Emanuel to put much in writing. While Lightfoot would often respond to text messages with voluminous essays that sometimes bordered on venomous, Johnson usually replies with a phone call or directs his staff to return the message.

The sea change may also be a sign of the times, as politicians are increasingly wary of sending electronic communications that are subject to public records requests.

In 2018, the Tribune won a lawsuit against the Emanuel administration over his failure to turn over records from personal devices and accounts that he used to conduct city business, a ruling that curtailed Illinois politicians

Turn to Texts, Page 5

Agreements aid truces in Gaza, Lebanon

Deals said to avert crises for Israel and the Palestinians

By Kareem Chehayeb and Abby Sewell
Associated Press

MAYS AL-JABAL, Lebanon — Israeli forces in southern Lebanon opened fire Sunday on protesters demanding their withdrawal in line with a cease-fire agreement, killing at least 22 and injuring 124, Lebanese health officials reported.

Hours later, the White House said Israel and Lebanon had agreed to extend the deadline to Feb. 18 for Israeli troops to depart southern Lebanon, after Israel requested more time to withdraw beyond the 60-day deadline stipulated in a cease-fire agreement that halted the Israel-Hezbollah war in late November.

After a similar stand-off in Gaza, mediator Qatar announced early Monday that an agreement has been reached to release an Israeli civilian hostage and allow Palestinians to return to northern Gaza, easing the first major crisis of the fragile ceasefire between Israel and Iran-backed Hamas.

In Gaza, thousands of Palestinians have gathered, waiting to move north through the Netzarim corridor bisecting

Turn to Mideast, Page 4



State Sen. Graciela Guzmán, left, talks Sunday with a woman outside a home where a man was detained by federal immigration officers earlier in the day in the 4300 block of West Dickens Avenue in the Hermosa neighborhood of Chicago. ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

'We are terrified'

ICE begins long-promised immigration blitz in Chicago

By Laura Rodríguez Presa, Nell Salzman, Adriana Pérez, Caroline Kubzansky and Jonathan Bullington
Chicago Tribune

It was around 8 a.m. Sunday when a family friend called Maria to ask why her husband of nearly 10 years hadn't shown up for work.

Minutes later, with federal immigration agents banging on the front door of her apartment in Chicago's Hermosa neighborhood, she had an answer.

Maria's husband was one of an as-yet-unknown number of people taken into custody Sunday morning in what appeared to be the opening salvo in the long-promised — and much-feared — federal immigration blitz on Chicago.

U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement spokesman Jeff Carter issued a statement Sunday saying that ICE and partner federal agencies "began conducting enhanced targeted operations today in Chicago to enforce U.S. immigration law and preserve public safety and national security by keeping potentially dangerous (criminals) out of our communities."

ICE announced it had arrested 1,000 people nationwide Sunday, but a spokesperson declined to say how many were from the Chicago area. Last year, the Biden administration averaged about 310 immigration arrests per day.



Border Czar Tom Homan talks with law enforcement from the Drug Enforcement Administration, the Department of Homeland Security and the Department of Justice about their immigration enforcement efforts. U.S. DRUG ENFORCEMENT ADMINISTRATION CHICAGO DIVISION

Chicagoans and advocates for undocumented immigrants reported at least a half-dozen ICE sightings across the city and suburbs Sunday.

"One raid is one too many, regardless of where it takes place," read a statement Sunday from a

coalition of immigration advocacy organizations.

Raids disrupt communities, sow fear, separate families

The operations were carried out with two top Trump administration officials in Chicago. The

Drug Enforcement Administration's Chicago field office posted a picture on X of Deputy Attorney General Emil Bove and "border czar" Tom Homan meeting with federal agents Sunday morning.

Turn to Raids, Page 2

Trump order freezes funding for Illinois EV charging network

Move raises questions about other clean energy projects

By Nara Schoenberg
Chicago Tribune

In its quest to get a million electric vehicles on the road by 2030, Illinois was counting on \$148 million in federal funding to help build a statewide network of public EV chargers.

Now that funding has been frozen — and targeted for possible reduction or elimination — under a wide-ranging executive order that President Donald Trump signed on his first day in office.

Also in limbo: another federal program that was to provide Illinois with millions of dollars for public EV chargers.

"I'm very nervous right now that (the Trump executive order) is going to limit Illinois' ability to achieve its EV future," said Brian Urbaszewski, environmental health programs director at the Chicago-based Respiratory Health Association.

If the federal funding drops or disappears, "it really puts that (1 million EV) goal that we have in Illinois in jeopardy," he said.

EVs and their chargers appear to be a prime target of Trump's "Unleashing American Energy" executive order, but they are by

no means the only Illinois clean energy projects that could be in for a bumpy ride as the president takes bold steps to reverse the ambitious clean energy policies of his predecessor.

The executive order pauses funds coming from President Joe Biden's signature climate law, the Inflation Reduction Act, including incentives for solar and wind projects and a federal tax credit of up to \$7,500 for EV buyers.

The executive order also targets the opportunity for states to adopt California-style vehicle emissions rules that exceed national standards, an approach

Turn to Energy, Page 3

INSIDE

Eagles decisively win ticket to Super Bowl LIX

Quarterback Jalen Hurts and the Eagles will go to the Super Bowl for the second time in three seasons after their dominant 55-23 victory over the Commanders in Philadelphia. **Chicago Sports**

David Schwimmer 'doubling down' on Lookingglass

After an existential crisis and a hiatus of close to two years, the famous Chicago theater company returns this week, with Schwimmer on the board and aiming to drum up investment. **Arts & Living**

